Scott Spitze, PhD

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Summary

I'm a labor economist with 3+ years experience in translating client's economic questions into actionable intelligence. I'm experienced in asking and answering research questions, cleaning and analyzing data, leading and mentoring research teams, and communicating with and understanding clients. I'm an expert in R and the tidyverse, including using these tools to interact with SQL databases.

Work Experience

- **The Burning Glass Institute**
  Senior Economist June 2023 - Present
  Economist March 2022 - May 2023

  - I mainly work on client based projects studying how to improve outcomes for workers, either though education, skills, or occupation selection. Notable projects include
    1. I led a system-wide analysis of the University of North Carolina (UNC) school system on a program-by-program basis. Using administrative data, I estimated long-run earnings and my team estimated the ROI for each program in the UNC system. We also used our own data to track worker occupation and location destinations and to estimate supply and demand for new graduates.
    2. I led the analysis behind the Credential Value Index, which is the largest independent measure of non-degree credential quality. This work included standardizing raw text data on credentials and providers, building a data set based on worker career history profiles of credential earners and counterfactual workers, and analyzing worker outcomes to measure wage gains, promotion rates, skills learned, and more.
    3. Led analysis for a report on the best starting jobs for non-college workers using a combination of public and private data sets on worker histories and job quality. (See NY Times coverage.)
  - I take client questions and translate them into actionable analysis.
  - I supervise fellow members of the research team: ensuring they have a balanced work load, regularly meeting for project feedback and advice, and checking the quality of their work.
  - Created an R package to streamline interaction with the company Snowflake server.

Education

2022 PhD (Economics) at **University of Georgia**
2018 MA (Economics, Doctoral Track) at **University of Iowa**
2015 BA (Economics) at **University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign**

Skills

Programming Languages	R (expert); Python (intermediate); Stata (intermediate); SQL (intermediate)
Econometric Methods	Regressions; Differences-in-Differences; Instrumental Variables; Synthetic Controls; Random Forests

Last updated: September 29, 2025